

Course Map for Fundamentals of Music Production

Course Outcomes:

Your course outcomes are the broad takeaways students will walk away with at the end of your course. Most courses have 2 – 3 course outcomes, though in some cases more are required by a department or accrediting body. Use this section to list out your course learning outcomes, and add more to this list as needed.

After completing this course, students will be able to:

- C1. Bring a musical idea to life using music production software
- C2. Understand and utilize the landscape of third-party Virtual Instruments and Plugins
- C3. Enhance projects using audio effects and automation techniques
- C4. Mix and master music projects

Module 1: Basics of Ableton Live

Topics Covered

- How to get Ableton Live running on your computer and ensuring it outputs sound
- How to add audio and midi clips to Ableton in Arrangement View
- Using midi tracks, outputting audio with basic sounds, presets, and the piano roll
- Splitting, combining, trimming, and fading audio clips

After Module 1, students will be able to:

In place of [Topic], list the broad topic(s) that will be covered throughout the week to provide students with a rough idea of what to expect. Then using the table below, create a list of the module learning outcomes, assessments, and course materials that students will work through as a part of the module. The Course Outcome Alignment column is used to indicate how each module learning outcome might align with the larger course outcomes. You can add or remove more rows as needed, and you may have assessments and course materials that align with more than one Module Learning Outcome.

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
<i>What measurable and specific goal(s) do students need to meet in this module?</i>	<i>How will students show you they've achieved the goal/outcome?</i>	<i>What resources, activities, and materials will students need to review in order to support their</i>	<i>With which course outcomes(s) does/do these module outcomes</i>

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
		<i>achievement of the learning goal/outcome?</i>	<i>align?</i>
Download and configure Ableton Live	Export first mini-project as .mp3 or .wav and submission. (Personal Project 1)	• Ableton Live 10 or 11 • Computer • May need to review Ableton Live docs for help	C1, C2
Add audio and midi tracks in arrangement view, edit audio files with splitting, combining, and trimming	Personal Project 1	• Ableton Live 10 or 11 • Computer	C1
Create loops using basic Ableton sounds and midi tracks	Personal Project 1	• Ableton Live 10 or 11 • Computer • How to use piano roll • How to export Ableton Live projects	C2

Table 1

Module 2: Sounds, Recording, VSTs, and Plugins

Topics Covered:

- Basic Synths and Presets Ableton Live provides
- Exploring ADSR with Ableton's Drift synth
- VSTS and Plugins
- Recording in Ableton

After module 2, students will be able to:

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
Explore Ableton Live presets and utilize Attack, Decay, Sustain,	Personal Project 2 using sounds with different ADSR	Ableton Live	C2

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
Release			
Locate and compile a list of free VSTs/Plugin resources	Resource List Compilation Live Doc	Ableton Live Google Docs	C2
Add, edit, and configure VSTs and Plugins	Personal Project 2 incorporation at least 1 VST or Plugin	Ableton Live Free VST or Plugin of your choice	C1, C2
Supplemental/Optional: Record Live Instruments in Ableton	Personal Project 2	Ableton Live Microphone Any Instrument or your voice	C1, C2

Table 2

Module 3: Audio Effects and Automation

Topics Covered:

- Basic effects in Ableton
- The frequency spectrum
- Compression: When and how to use it
- Automation and filtering

After module 3, students will be able to:

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
Incorporate Reverb and Delay audio effects into their projects	Personal Project 3 incorporating both reverb and delay effects	Ableton Live	C3
Use advanced effects (Equalization and Compression) to enhance their music	Frequency Spectrum Analysis	Ableton Live	C3
Utilize automation and filtering techniques to evolve and change effects and sounds over time	Personal Project 3 incorporating automated effects and filtered sounds	Ableton Live	C3, C4

Table 3

Module 4: Mixing and Mastering

Topics Covered

- Using EQ techniques to mix a project
- Basic effect chains in Ableton for mastering
- Volume Control and reference material

After module 4, students will be able to:

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
Use EQ to boost and cut wanted and unwanted frequencies	Personal Project 4 utilizing EQ8 in Ableton Live	Ableton Live	C4
Explore and utilize Ableton Effect Chain presets	Personal Project 4 utilizing at least 1 effect chain	Ableton Live	C3, C4
Balance channel volumes to achieve desired volume in their project export	Personal Project 4 revisit with adjusted channel volumes	Ableton Live	C4

Table 4

Module 5: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 5

Module 6: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 6

Module 7: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 7

Module 8: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 8

Module 9: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 9

Module 10: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 10

Module 11: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 11

Module 12: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 12

Module 13: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 13

Module 14: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 14

Module 15: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Table 15